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SUPERSEDING
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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BOX, INDEX CARD, CLOTH COVERED WOOD OR FIBER

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers coated cloth covered wood or fiber index card boxes with hinged covers

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Grade and type.* The boxes shall be of one grade and one type.

1.2.2 *Classes.* The boxes shall be of the following classes, as specified (see 6.2):

Class A—With hinged cover, for 3- by 5-inch, 4- by 6-inch, and 5- by 8-inch cards.

Class B—With hinged cover and hinged drop front, for 3- by 5-inch cards.

1.2.3 *Dimensions.* The boxes shall be the dimensions indicated in tables I and II, for the card sizes as specified (see 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-268—Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage

FSC 7520

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 *Basic material.* The basic material of which the box is fabricated shall be binders' board, solid wood, plywood, hard pressed fiberboard, or a combination of these materials.

3.1.2 *Covering material.* The exterior covering of the box shall be black coated cloth having a semilustrous leather grain finish.

3.1.3 *Lining material.* The lining material shall be a white or light colored paper.

3.2 Design. The box shall have a hinged cover which shall open 180°. The box exterior shall be completely covered with the coated cloth specified in 3.1.2. The box interior shall be fully lined with lining material specified in 3.1.3, unless the basic material of the box is white lined binders' board. When closed the box shall be of uniform height on all sides.

3.2.1 *Class A-index card box with hinged cover.* The front of the lower portion of the box shall be approximately one half inch lower than the back of the lower portion of the box, to permit easy accessibility to the contents. The back of the cover shall be not less than one inch high as measured from the hinge. The cover sides shall overlap the lower portion of the box approximately one half inch and shall form a flush outside surface.

3.2.2 *Class B-index card box with hinged cover and drop front.* The box shall have a hinged drop front which opens 180°. The front shall be hinged within one half inch of the center to form the drop front. The cover sides shall overlap the top of the lower portion of the box by approximately one inch and shall form a flush outside surface.

3.3 Construction. All vertical corners shall be reinforced with one inch width cloth tape tightly cemented to the corner or shall be reinforced by stapling. Cloth tape reinforcing shall cover the entire corner and shall extend a minimum of 3/8 inch on each side of the corner and a minimum of 1/4 inch over the edge and into the inside of the box. Staple reinforcements, when used in lieu of cloth tape, shall be located at a minimum of two points on each vertical corner of the lower portion and a minimum of one point on each vertical corner of the cover. The staples shall extend a minimum of 3/8 inch on each side of the corner. Covers and drop fronts, when applicable, shall be fully hinged with one inch width cloth tape inside and outside. The covering material shall be continuous over the outside tape hinge, cover, and lower portion of the box to provide additional hinge strength. The outside covering shall uniformly extend inside the box at least 1/4 inch. The box shall be lined with smooth and neatly applied lining material conforming to 3.1.3, when required. The construction shall be such that the sides of the box shall not break or crack and the corners shall not tear when tested as specified in 4.3.

3.4 Dimensions.

3.4.1 *Class A.*

3.4.1.1 *Material thickness.* The overall material thickness of the cover, back and bottom shall be not less than 0.08 inch and the sides and front of the lower portion of the box shall be not less than 0.15 inch thick below the shoulder.

3.4.1.2 *Inside dimensions.* The inside dimensions for each size box shall be as shown in table I.

3.4.2 *Class B.*

3.4.2.1 *Material thickness.* The overall material thickness of the cover, back, sides

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TABLE I. *(Dimensions in inches)*

Card size	Height		Width		Depth	
	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
3 by 5	3-3/8	3-3/4	5-1/8	5-1/2	2-5/8	3
3 by 5	3-3/8	3-3/4	5-1/8	5-1/2	5-7/8	6-1/4
4 by 6	4-3/8	4-3/4	6-1/8	6-1/2	2-5/8	3
5 by 8	5-3/8	5-3/4	8-1/8	8-1/2	2-5/8	3

TABLE II. *(Dimensions in inches)*

Card size	Height		Width		Depth	
	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
3 by 5	3-3/8	3-3/4	5-1/8	5-1/2	5-7/8	6-1/4

and bottom of the box shall be not less than 0.08 inch. The front shall be not less than 0.15 inch thick.

3.4.2.2 *Inside dimensions.* The inside dimensions of the box shall be as shown in table II.

3.5 Identification marking. Each box shall be permanently and legibly marked with the name or trademark of the manufacturer.

3.6 Workmanship. The boxes shall be free from any defects and imperfections which affect the appearance or which might impair the serviceability. Covering and lining, when required, shall be applied and cemented so as to present a smooth uniform appearance and corners shall be neatly made. The cover shall open and close smoothly.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specifications where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 *Inspection of materials and components.* The supplier is responsible for insuring that materials and components used were manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the specified requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified or, if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 *Size of lot.* All index card boxes of one class and size presented for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of examination and test.

4.2.2 *Sampling and inspection for acceptance.* Sampling and inspection for acceptance shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.2.3 *Examination of the end item.* The examination shall be based on an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units and shall be in accordance with the defects listed in table III. The sample unit shall be one box sampled at inspection level S-4.

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TABLE III. *Visual and dimensional defects*

Not class specified.
Not size specified.
Exterior covering not coated cloth having a semi-lustrous leather grain finish.
Cover does not open 180°.
Front of lower portion not approximately one-half inch lower than back of lower portion for class A.
Back of cover less than one inch high for class A.
Box, when closed, not of uniform height on all sides.
Cover sides of class A box do not overlap shoulder approximately one-half inch.
Outside surface of cover and lower portion not flush.
Front of class B box not hinged within 1/2 inch of the center to form a drop front.
Drop front (when applicable) does not open 180°.
Cover of class B box does not overlap the top of lower portion approximately one inch.
Vertical corners not reinforced.
Cloth tape corner reinforcement not tightly cemented.
Cloth tape corner reinforcement does not extend a minimum of 3/8 inch on each side of corner.
Cloth tape corner reinforcement does not extend into the inside at least one fourth inch.
Cover and drop front, when applicable, not hinged with cloth tape inside and outside.
Covering material not continuous over outside tape hinge.
Outside covering does not extend uniformly inside box at least one fourth inch.
Overall material thickness of the cover, back, or bottom of the class A box less than 0.08 inch.
Overall material thickness of the sides or front of lower portion of the class A box less than 0.15 inch.
Overall material thickness of the cover, back, sides, or bottom of the class B box less than 0.08 inch.
Overall material thickness of the front of the class B box less than 0.15 inch.
Inside dimensions not in accordance with table I or II (as applicable).
Exterior not black.
Interior not fully lined with white or light colored paper, when required.
Not permanently marked with manufacturer's name or trademark.
Covering material not smoothly applied and devoid of wrinkles, bubbles and ragged edges.
Lining not smooth or not neatly applied.
Corners not smooth or not neatly made.
Cover binds on corner when opening or closing.
Cover does not close properly.

4.2.4 *Testing of the end item.* Testing shall be done at inspection level S-3 on index card boxes selected from those sampled in accordance with 4.2.3 and at an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.3.

4.2.5 *Inspection of preparation for delivery.* An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table IV. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers offered for delivery at one time. The inspection level shall be II and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV. *Classification of preparation for delivery defects*

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.

4.3 Construction-strength test. Apply a 20 pound force to the inside surface of one side of the lower portion of the box in a direction perpendicular to the surface. The force shall be uniformly distributed over an area one inch square located at the top edge one inch from the back corner. The load shall be gradually applied over a period of not less than five seconds and shall be maintained at 20 pounds for a period of five minutes. The box shall be maintained in position by an opposing pressure against the inside surface directly opposite the surface to which the force is applied. The restraining pressure shall be uniformly distributed over an area one inch square located at the top edge one inch from the back corner.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.)

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A or B.* Each index card box shall be wrapped with paper conforming to UU-P-268 and secured with tape.

5.1.2 *Level C.* The boxes shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Index card boxes of one class and size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in the most compact manner in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed with a case liner or tape, and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding, in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The weight of contents shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Twenty-four index card boxes of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The boxes shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination, at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard pack (civil agency procurements). The standard pack for civil agency procurements shall be as specified in 5.1.1 and 5.2.2 (see 6.3).

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 *Military activities.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Index card boxes are intended to be used as a file box for the maintenance of index cards or forms printed on card stock.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Class, card size, and depth of box (1.2.2 and 1.2.3).

(*c*) Inspection responsibility, if other than as specified herein (4.1).

(*d*) Applicable levels of packaging and packing required (5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Standard pack for civil agencies. The standard pack requirements in 5.3 are intended for use in procurements of stores stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot or intermediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue, or shipment to eventual user.

6.4 Transportation description. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

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Wooden

Rail:

Boxes, wooden, not otherwise indexed by name, not nested.
Carload minimum weights 12,000 and 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:

Boxes, wooden, not otherwise indexed, set-up, not nested.
Truckload minimum weights: 10,000, 14,000, 20,000 and 36,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Fibreboard

Rail:

Boxes, fibreboard, not otherwise indexed by name, outside measurements exceeding 1 inch in depth but not exceeding 15 united inches, length, width and depth added, in packages.

Rail:

Boxes, fibreboard, not otherwise indexed by name, outside measurements exceeding 1 inch in depth and exceeding 15 united inches, length, width and depth added, in packages.
Carload minimum weights 10,000 and 14,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:

Boxes, fibreboard, not otherwise indexed, set-up, outside measurements exceeding 1 inch in depth but not exceeding 15 united inches, length, width and depth added, in packages.

Motor:

Boxes, fibreboard, not otherwise indexed, set-up, outside measurements exceeding 1 inch in depth and exceeding 15 united inches, length, width and depth added, in boxes.
Truckload minimum weight 12,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification—A-8.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—GL
Navy—SA
Air Force—69

Interested Activities:

User
Army—SM
Navy—MC

Reviewer and user information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current Federal Supply Classification Listing of DOD Standardization Documents.

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